

Chapter 122-1

The moment Liang Shi's words came out, everyone present was shocked.

Only Yang Jiani's pupils dilated for a few seconds when she heard the two words "Qi Jiao," and her struggling body suddenly froze.

Chen Mian, standing behind Liang Shi, adjusted her glasses. Anger flashed through those world-weary eyes as she stared directly at Yang Jiani.

"It's you..." Yang Jiani noticed Chen Mian standing in the back.

That ink-blue shoulder-length hair was loose and languid. She naturally carried an air of laziness about her.

She was clearly standing together with everyone else, yet seemed like a person from a different world.

Chen Mian curved her lips in a mocking smile, "You still remember me."

Yang Jiani repeated herself haltingly several times, but it was just those same two words over and over.

—It's you.

Chen Mian's gaze gradually turned cold, as if she were looking at a dead person.

A moment later, Yang Jiani was like a maddened wild beast, struggling again, even more violently than before.

Her eyes were bloodshot red. The cold metal handcuffs were stained with her blood, silver turning to crimson, yet she didn't notice at all. Her hair fell scattered on both sides of her face as she let out a voice-cracking roar at the two of them.

The sound was so loud that the two police officers holding her instinctively frowned. They tried their best to press down on her shoulders but were still injured by her constant struggling.

The police officers were strong enough, but because Yang Jiani was in a completely maddened state right now, she didn't care about her own body at all—even injuries could be ignored.

Like a cornered beast desperately trying to break through its cage.

As if her enemies were outside the cage.

After that roar, Yang Jiani cursed loudly with her voice-cracked, broken-gong voice, "All of you people! Just go die!"

She had originally been an opera performer with a beautiful voice. When she spoke normally, it naturally carried a clarity to it.

Like spring stream water flowing clearly over rocks.

But now her voice was completely damaged. It was rare to see someone damage their vocal cords purely from screaming in rage—it showed just how desperate and furious she was.

Yang Jiani had lost all her former grace. She spat in the direction of Chen Mian and Liang Shi. Fortunately, the two dodged in time.

That glob of spit landed on the wall.

It was tinged with blood.

Yang Jiani's tears were murky, mixed with her deathly pale makeup.

She looked like a midnight ghost, somewhat terrifying.

"It's all because of you people!" Yang Jiani screamed at the top of her lungs. "Chen Mian! You're the one who should have died! It's you!"

"Why did my Jiaojiao have to die! You go die! Why didn't you go with her! It's all your fault! You killed my Jiaojiao!" As Yang Jiani screamed, she collapsed to her knees from exhaustion.

Liang Shi glanced at Chen Mian, only to see Chen Mian staring at Yang Jiani expressionlessly.

But her slightly trembling body betrayed her emotions.

Chen Mian swallowed, her slender neck radiating a sickly, dazzling white under the cold sunlight.

Chen Mian's voice was very cold, like shards of ice in the depths of winter¹, transforming into a sharp knife stabbing into one's heart. "Qi Jiao died because of you."

Chen Mian said, "Because of your excessive control and morbid possessiveness, you made her life neither human nor ghost². That's why she went to die."

"It was you." Chen Mian said, "You gave her life, yet you also strangled her soul."

Chen Mian's tears suddenly fell through the air—without any crying, a single crystalline tear simply dropped.

She gave people the feeling of being cold and distant, as if she wouldn't be moved by anything in this world.

But when Qi Jiao was mentioned, she would briefly reveal human characteristics.

Tenderness, anger, warmth.

Chen Mian's icy voice echoed faintly, "You're the one who should have died, Yang Jiani."

"Because you didn't die." Chen Mian continued, "And Qi Jiao didn't want you to die either—that's why she went to die."

Yang Jiani was stunned by her words, her struggling movements stopping. The leader nearby saw this and immediately directed people to drag Yang Jiani away from the crime scene.

Chen Mian turned around, no longer facing the crowd.

The place briefly fell into silence.

This confrontation left everyone completely confused, not understanding what they were talking about at all.

The person in charge of this case was Officer Sun from the Criminal Investigation Brigade. He quickly pulled himself out of that heart-shaking confrontation, gathered his thoughts, and asked Liang Shi, "What did you say just now? What else do you want to report?"

Liang Shi repeated her earlier words, "I said, what I want to report is that Yang Jiani killed her daughter Qi Jiao."

Officer Sun said, "The report we received from you earlier was about this. Currently, the victim is being emergency rescued at the hospital. The hospital sent word that she needs a blood transfusion but hasn't passed away yet."

"No." Liang Shi shook her head lightly.

She glanced in the direction Yang Jiani had been taken and said resoundingly, "The person being rescued at the hospital is Gu Xingyue, not Qi Jiao."

Liang Shi's next words overturned everyone present's understanding.

She said, "Yang Jiani's attack on Gu Xingyue was intentional harm—attempted murder. But her real daughter Qi Jiao died thirteen years ago."

Shortly after Qi Jiao jumped from the building, she pushed Qi Jiao, who had just returned from the gates of hell, back in again.

Footnotes:

¹ **Depths of winter (三九寒天):** Refers to the "San Jiu" period, the coldest days of winter in the Chinese calendar. "San Jiu" literally means "three nines," referring to the third nine-day period after the Winter Solstice, traditionally considered the coldest time of year.

² **Neither human nor ghost (人不人鬼不鬼):** A Chinese expression describing a miserable existence where someone is barely living—not quite alive like a human, not quite dead like a ghost. It describes an unbearable state of living.